

CERTIFICATE OF PROJECT APPROVAL

Capstone Project Authorisation - Milestone (part of academic requirements for Project Management T4)

This is to certify that the following project has been presented before the Faculty Guide and is approved for academic submission. The project has been reviewed based on its relevance, feasibility, academic value, and alignment with the course objectives.

PROJECT DETAILS

COMPANY / BRAND SELECTED Rapido (Industry Partner: AOS Digital Solution)
PROJECT TITLE Scalable Workforce Management for Rapido Driver Onboarding
TEAM NUMBER 10

TEAM MEMBERS

S.NO.	NAME
1	Shruti
2	Ketki
3	Saranga Vinod
4	Shreya Bharara
5 (optional)	

JUSTIFICATION FOR SELECTING THIS PROJECT

S. no	Category	Remarks
1	Value Prop (How does this project contribute to growth, efficiency, customer satisfaction, compliance?)	The project proposes a scalable workforce management system for Rapido that streamlines recruitment, attendance tracking, vendor management, and payments for field executives. It improves operational efficiency, reduces costs, and supports nationwide expansion.
2	Resource Availability (Can we acquire budget, talent, time, infra? Will a real stakeholder join the team?)	The project is supported by AOS Digital Solution, providing access to industry insights and stakeholder inputs. It primarily requires secondary research, interviews, and process analysis, making it feasible within the available time and resources.
3	Feasibility (Is this project technically or operationally feasible?)	The proposed vendor-based workforce management framework and HRMS design are operationally and technically feasible. The project focuses on process design rather than software development or implementation.
4	Risk Assessment (What are the project's financial, operational and legal risks? Can they be mitigated?)	Potential risks include limited access to internal company data, dependence on vendor information, and changing operational requirements. These risks can be mitigated through secondary research, stakeholder discussions, and documented assumptions.
5.	Industry Contact Details (Contact person, designation, official phone number/email)	ABHISHRK RANJAN 9122120986

FACULTY APPROVAL

FACULTY SIGNATURE

PROJECT STATUS

☒ Approved ☐ Approved with Suggestions ☐ Revision Required

This certificate confirms that the above-mentioned project has been reviewed, evaluated, and approved by the Faculty Guide for academic submission.

PROJECT CHARTER

Project Title	Scalable Workforce Management for Rapido Driver Onboarding	Project Manager	Team 10
Project Start Date	8th August 2026	Project End Date	15 th September 2026

Business Need

Rapido is rapidly expanding its Auto and E-Rickshaw services across India, requiring thousands of temporary field executives to onboard drivers. Managing recruitment, deployment, attendance, payroll, and performance of this distributed workforce across multiple cities creates significant operational complexity and cost. Therefore, Rapido requires a scalable workforce management system that integrates recruitment, vendor management, HRMS, attendance tracking, and centralized payments to support efficient nationwide expansion.

In Scope	Out of Scope
- Design a scalable workforce recruitment and vendor management model. - Develop an HRMS framework with GPS-based attendance and centralized payment processes. - Prepare an implementation roadmap for scaling workforce operations across cities.	- No recruitment, hiring, or vendor selection of field executives. - No HRMS/GPS software development or vendor contract negotiations. - No financial decisions or operational execution of driver onboarding.

Deliverables	Risks & Issues	Assumptions / Dependencies
- Analyse Rapido's field workforce requirements. - Design a digital recruitment process. - Develop a vendor-based workforce model. - Design an HRMS with GPS attendance tracking.	- Limited access to Rapido's internal operations data. - Difficulty coordinating with vendors across multiple cities. - Inconsistent GPS/attendance data quality in the field. - Delays or disputes in vendor payment cycles.	- Rapido will share non-confidential operational information. - Local manpower vendors will be available for engagement. - Secondary/industry data will supplement primary research. - Framework will be designed for multi-city applicability.

Financials

Budget to complete this project is ₹80,000.

Milestone	Target Completion Date	Actual Date
Project Selection	4 Aug 2026	4 August, 2026
Project Charter Submission	6 Aug 2026	6 August, 2026
Requirement & Data Collection	13 Aug 2026	
Process & Workforce Analysis	21 Aug 2026	
Framework Design & Recommendations	11 Sep 2026	
Final Report & Presentation	15 Sep 2026	

Project Manager	Team 10
Sponsor	Abhishek Ranjan
Team Members	Ajeet Ojasvi, Namrata

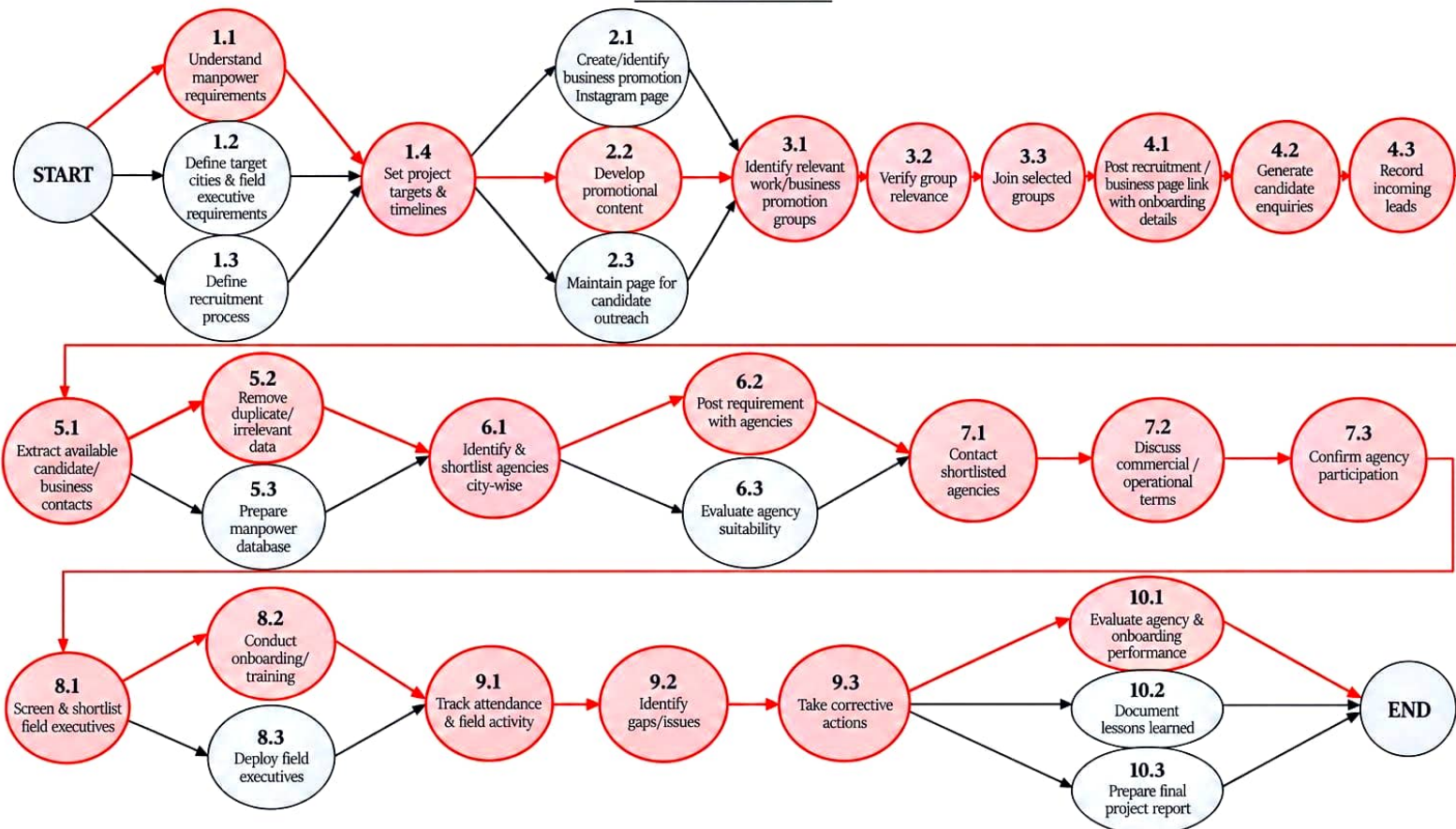
WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE WITH GANTT CHART

Scalable Workforce Management for Rapido Driver Onboarding | 08 Aug – 15 Sep 2026

WBS Number	Task	Owner	Start	End	Duration (days)	% Complete	Week 1 (08/03)					Week 2 (08/10)					Week 3 (08/17)					Week 4 (08/24)					Week 5 (08/31)					Week 6 (09/07)					Week 7 (09/14)				
							M	T	W	R	F	M	T	W	R	F	M	T	W	R	F	M	T	W	R	F	M	T	W	R	F	M	T	W	R	F	M	T	W	R	F
1.0	Project Initiation & Planning	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	08/08/26	08/11/26	3	100%																																			
1.1	Understand manpower requirement	Saranga, Ketki	08/08/26	08/10/26	2	100%																																			
1.2	Define target cities & field executive requirement	Shruti, Shreya	08/09/26	08/10/26	1	100%																																			
1.3	Define recruitment process	Saranga, Ketki	08/10/26	08/10/26	1	100%																																			
1.4	Set project targets and timelines	Shruti, Shreya	08/10/26	08/11/26	1	100%																																			
2.0	Digital Promotion Setup	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	08/11/26	08/14/26	3	100%																																			
2.1	Create/identify business promotion Instagram page	Saranga, Ketki	08/11/26	08/12/26	1	100%																																			
2.2	Develop promotional content	Shruti, Shreya	08/12/26	08/13/26	1	100%																																			
2.3	Maintain page for candidate outreach	Saranga, Ketki	08/13/26	08/14/26	1	100%																																			
3.0	City-wise Community Identification	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	08/14/26	08/17/26	3	100%																																			
3.1	Identify relevant work/business promotion groups	Saranga, Ketki	08/14/26	08/15/26	1	100%																																			
3.2	Verify group relevance	Shruti, Shreya	08/15/26	08/17/26	2	100%																																			
3.3	Join selected groups	Saranga, Ketki	08/16/26	08/17/26	1	100%																																			
4.0	Digital Lead Generation	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	08/17/26	08/20/26	3	67%																																			
4.1	Post Instagram/business page link with onboarding	Saranga, Ketki	08/17/26	08/18/26	1	100%																																			
4.2	Generate candidate enquiries	Shruti, Shreya	08/18/26	08/19/26	1	100%																																			
4.3	Record incoming leads	Saranga, Ketki	08/19/26	08/20/26	1	0%																																			
5.0	Data Extraction & Lead Management	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	08/20/26	08/24/26	4	0%																																			
5.1	Extract available candidate/business contacts	Saranga, Ketki	08/20/26	08/22/26	2	0%																																			
5.2	Remove duplicate/irrelevant data	Shruti, Shreya	08/22/26	08/24/26	2	0%																																			
5.3	Prepare manpower sourcing database	Saranga, Ketki	08/23/26	08/24/26	1	0%																																			
6.0	Manpower Agency Sourcing	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	08/24/26	08/29/26	5	0%																																			
6.1	Identify & shortlist agencies city-wise	Saranga, Ketki	08/24/26	08/26/26	2	0%																																			
6.2	Post requirement with agencies	Shruti, Shreya	08/26/26	08/28/26	2	0%																																			
6.3	Evaluate agency suitability	Saranga, Ketki	08/28/26	08/29/26	1	0%																																			
7.0	Agency Engagement & Coordination	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	08/29/26	09/02/26	4	0%																																			
7.1	Contact shortlisted agencies	Saranga, Ketki	08/29/26	08/31/26	2	0%																																			
7.2	Discuss commercial/operational terms	Shruti, Shreya	08/31/26	09/01/26	1	0%																																			
7.3	Confirm agency participation	Saranga, Ketki	09/01/26	09/02/26	1	0%																																			
8.0	Workforce Mobilization	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	09/02/26	09/07/26	5	0%																																			
8.1	Screen & select suitable field executives	Saranga, Ketki	09/02/26	09/04/26	2	0%																																			
8.2	Conduct onboarding/training	Shruti, Shreya	09/04/26	09/06/26	2	0%																																			
8.3	Deploy field executives	Saranga, Ketki	09/06/26	09/07/26	1	0%																																			
9.0	Workforce Monitoring	Team (All 4 - Rotating Pairs)	09/07/26	09/11/26	4	0%																																			
9.1	Track attendance & field activity	Saranga, Ketki	09/07/26	09/09/26	2	0%																																			
9.2	Identify gaps/issues	Shruti, Shreya	09/09/26	09/10/26	1	0%																																			
9.3	Take corrective actions	Saranga, Ketki	09/10/26	09/11/26	1	0%																																			
10.0	Project Closure & Evaluation	Saranga, Ketki, Shreya, Shruti	09/11/26	09/15/26	4	0%																																			
10.1	Evaluate agency & onboarding performance	Saranga, Ketki, Shreya, Shruti	09/11/26	09/13/26	2	0%																																			
10.2	Document lessons learned	Saranga, Ketki, Shreya, Shruti	09/13/26	09/14/26	1	0%																																			
10.3	Prepare final project report	Saranga, Ketki, Shreya, Shruti	09/14/26	09/15/26	1	0%																																			

Legend: Not started In progress Complete

Milestone 4



Legend:



Activity (non-critical)



Activity (critical path)



Precedence (non-critical)



Precedence (critical path)

MILESTONE- 5

Executive Summary

The project sponsor directed the team to complete the **Rapido driver onboarding project seven days ahead of the original schedule**, without reducing the project scope, while allowing the use of a limited, but not unlimited, budget to support schedule compression. At the time of this revision, **Phases 1.0 through 7.1 were 100% complete, while Phase 7.2 was 45% in progress**; therefore, the remaining activities formed the primary focus of the revised project plan. The original project completion date of **15 September 2026** was consequently brought forward to **8 September 2026**.

This report examines the project management principles used to respond to this time constraint and explains how they were applied to the project. The primary approach involved **fast-tracking**, by overlapping activities that could be performed in parallel, and **selective crashing**, by allocating additional resources only where they could meaningfully reduce project duration. The revised approach also considered **critical path management, resource allocation, cost–time trade-offs, risk management, quality control, and project monitoring** to ensure that the reduction in project duration did not compromise the intended project outcomes.

Particular attention was given to activities related to **agency engagement, workforce mobilization, monitoring, and project closure**, where opportunities existed to reduce waiting time and perform activities concurrently. The revised network logic was used to identify and protect the critical path, while the risk register was strengthened to address risks arising from the compressed schedule, including reduced float, agency delays, resource constraints, and potential implementation delays.

The objective of the revised plan is therefore to achieve the **8 September 2026 completion target while maintaining the original scope, controlling additional expenditure, and preserving the required quality of project deliverables**. No Work Breakdown Structure activity was added, removed, or renamed; instead, the project was re-sequenced and selectively resourced to achieve the required seven-day schedule reduction.

1. Project / CEO Challenge

The instruction received was direct: "I don't care how you do it, but finish the project 7 days earlier." Two conditions were attached to this instruction. First, the scope of the project could not change - every deliverable already committed to in the Work Breakdown Structure had to remain in the plan. Second, while budget was available to help compress the schedule, it was explicitly "not unlimited," meaning any spending decision had to be justified by the number of days it actually bought the project.

This is a textbook example of the project management "triple constraint" (also called the iron triangle) of scope, time, and cost. With scope fixed and time forced downward, cost becomes the only variable the team can adjust, and it must be adjusted deliberately rather than broadly. At the point this directive was issued, Phases 1.0 to 7.1 - covering project initiation, digital promotion, community identification, lead generation, data extraction, and agency sourcing - were already complete, and Phase 7.2 (discussing commercial and operational terms with shortlisted agencies) was 45% underway. This meant the seven days could only be recovered from the work that remained: the final stages of agency engagement, workforce mobilization, workforce monitoring, and project closure.

2. Schedule Compression Theory

Schedule compression is the set of techniques used to shorten a project's duration without changing its scope. It is only effective when applied to activities on the critical path - the sequence of activities with zero float (slack) that together determine the shortest possible completion date for the project. Shortening a non-critical activity does not shorten the project, because that activity already has spare time before it affects the finish date. For this reason, any compression decision must begin with identifying the current critical path, which in this project was documented in the Activity-on-Arrow network diagram (Milestone 4).

Project management literature recognises two standard schedule compression techniques - fast-tracking and crashing - each with a different cost and risk profile. A third option, reducing scope, was explicitly ruled out by the sponsor. The choice between fast-tracking and crashing, and the order in which they are applied, is itself a project management decision: fast-tracking is generally attempted first because it is close to cost-free, with crashing reserved for the remaining gap because it carries a direct cost.

3. Fast-Tracking and Crashing

Table 1 summarises the two techniques on the dimensions relevant to this project: definition, cost impact, principal risk, effect on activity sequencing, and the conditions under which each is the better choice.

Table 1: Fast-Tracking vs Crashing

Basis	Fast-Tracking	Crashing
Definition	Activities normally done in sequence are re-planned to run partly in parallel.	Additional resources (people, equipment, overtime) are added to a critical activity to shorten its duration.
Direct Cost	Little to no direct cost; mainly a coordination effort.	Direct cost increases, since extra manpower or resources must be paid for.
Primary Risk	Rework or errors if the overlapped activities depend on each other's outputs.	Diminishing returns and higher cost per day saved as more compression is applied; possible resource strain.
Effect on Logic/Sequence	Changes the sequencing/dependency logic between activities.	Sequence is unchanged; only the duration of the activity itself is reduced.
Best Used When	Dependent activities have some genuine flexibility to overlap without loss of quality.	Budget is available and the activity's duration is resource-driven (adding people genuinely speeds it up).
Applied In This Project	Workforce Monitoring (9.0) started before Workforce Mobilization (8.0) fully closed; Project Closure (10.0) started before Workforce Monitoring (9.0) fully closed.	Workforce Mobilization (8.0) and Workforce Monitoring (9.0) were each shortened by adding one temporary resource (an additional recruiter/trainer and an additional field supervisor respectively).

The two techniques are not mutually exclusive. In this project, both were used together on Workforce Monitoring (9.0): the activity was both started earlier through overlap with Workforce Mobilization (fast-tracking) and shortened through an additional field supervisor (crashing).

4. Application to Our Project

Because Phases 1.0 to 7.1 were already complete and Phase 7.2 was already in progress, compression was applied only from Phase 7.2 onward, and only where genuinely needed. Phases 7.2 and 7.3 (discussing terms and confirming agency participation) were retained at their original one-day durations, since they are judgment-based, relationship-driven steps that would not have been shortened safely by adding resources or forcing overlap. The full seven-day reduction was instead achieved across the three remaining execution phases, as summarised in Table 2.

Table 2: Schedule Compression Applied by WBS Phase

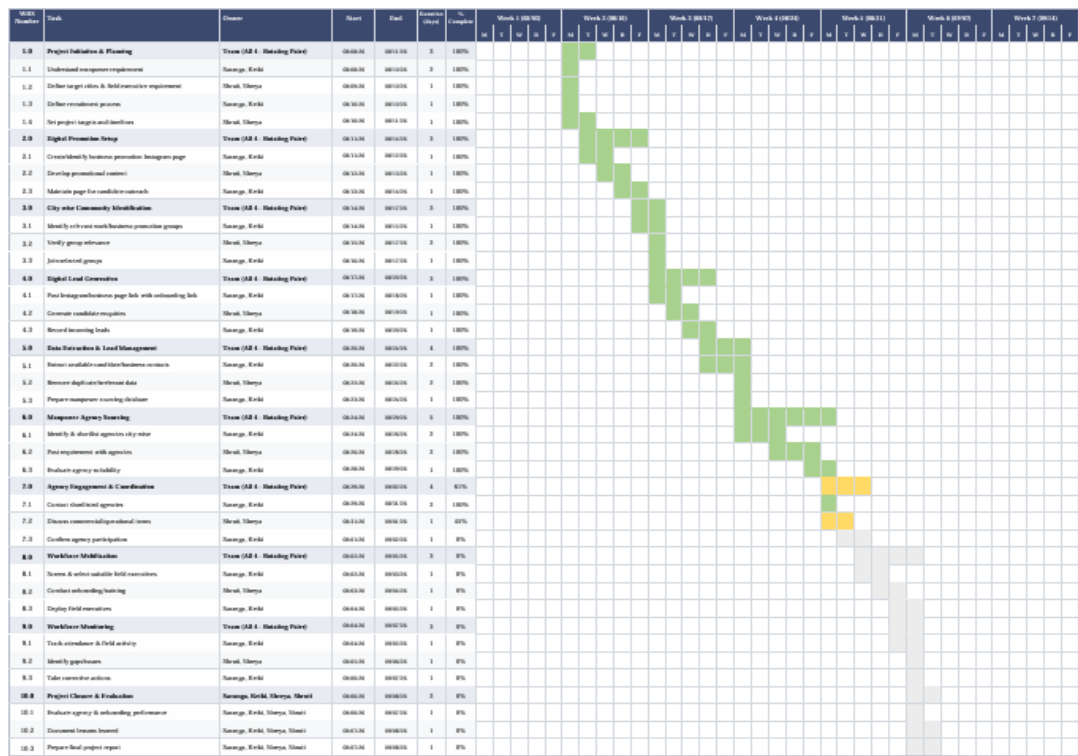
WBS Phase	Original Duration / Dates	Revised Duration / Dates	Technique Applied	How It Was Achieved
7.2 Discuss commercial/operational terms	1 day (31 Aug - 01 Sep)	1 day (unchanged) -	No compression required	Already a single-day activity; retained as planned.

WBS Phase	Original Duration / Dates	Revised Duration / Dates	Technique Applied	How It Was Achieved
		now 45% in progress		
7.3 Confirm agency participation	1 day (01-02 Sep)	1 day (unchanged)	No compression required	Already a single-day activity; retained as planned.
8.0 Workforce Mobilization	5 days (02-07 Sep)	3 days (02-05 Sep)	Crashing	One additional recruiter/trainer added so screening and onboarding batches run in parallel instead of one after another.
9.0 Workforce Monitoring	4 days (07-11 Sep)	3 days (04-07 Sep)	Fast-Tracking + Crashing	Monitoring begins one day before Mobilization fully closes (rolling start); one additional field supervisor added to cover more ground in less time.
10.0 Project Closure & Evaluation	4 days (11-15 Sep)	2 days (06-08 Sep)	Fast-Tracking	Evaluation and report drafting begin one day before Monitoring fully closes, using data as it becomes available.

Together, these changes move the project's completion date from 15 September 2026 to 8 September 2026 - a reduction of exactly seven calendar days - while every activity originally in the plan remains in the plan. The revised Milestone 3 Gantt chart reflects these updated dates, durations, and completion percentages phase by phase.

Revised M3:

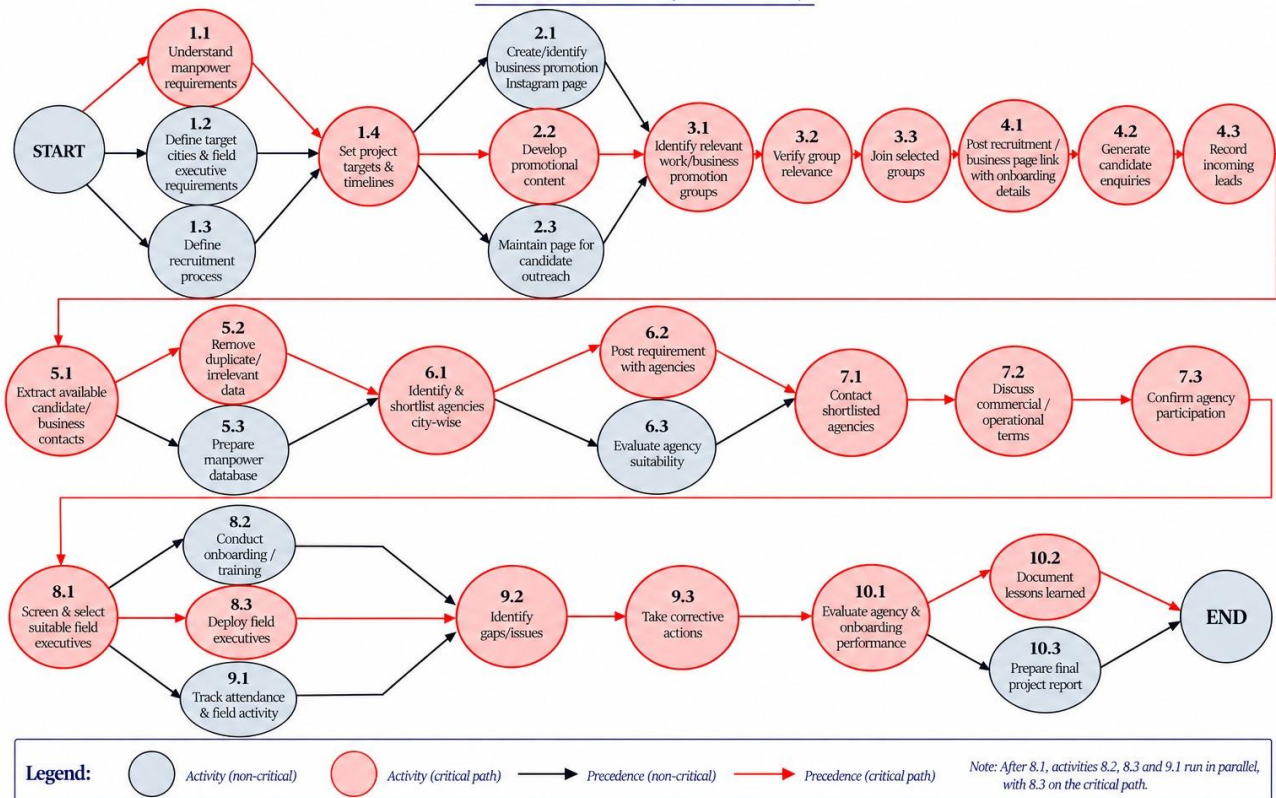
WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE WITH GANTT CHART



Legend: Not started In progress Complete

Revised M4:

Milestone 4 (Revised)



5. Critical Path Management

The revised Milestone 4 network diagram identifies the critical path (shown in red) running from the project start through to project end, with non-critical activities (shown in grey) carrying their own float and therefore posing less immediate schedule risk. The diagram's accompanying note - that after activity 8.1, activities 8.2, 8.3, and 9.1 run in parallel, with 8.3 remaining on the critical path - is the network-diagram expression of the same fast-tracking decision described in Section 5: monitoring work is allowed to begin before mobilization work has fully finished, without removing 8.3 (deployment) from the critical path.

Compressing the critical path has a direct consequence that must be actively managed: float across the remaining activities falls close to zero. This is formally identified as Risk R12 in the accompanying Risk Register - the post-compression critical path leaves almost no absorbing slack, so a delay anywhere on it threatens the 8 September finish date directly. Critical path management from this point onward therefore shifts from a planning exercise to a monitoring discipline: every activity on the red path in the revised network diagram must be tracked daily rather than weekly for the remainder of the project.

6. Resource Management

The project's core team of four members already operates on a rotating-pair ownership model, established in Milestone 3, so that no single individual is the sole owner of any activity. This structure was retained without change. Schedule compression added two temporary resources beyond the core team, targeted specifically at the two crashed phases: an additional recruiter/trainer to support Workforce Mobilization, and an additional field supervisor to support Workforce Monitoring. Both additions were chosen because they directly address activities whose duration is resource-driven - more trained hands genuinely process more field executives and monitor more drivers per day - rather than being spread thinly across activities where extra people would not meaningfully speed up the work.

A further resourcing risk specific to a student project team is addressed in the Risk Register (R9): overlapping coursework and examination commitments could remove a team member from a single-owner activity on a now zero-float critical path. The mitigation is to cross-train a backup owner for every critical-path activity and to circulate the revised network diagram so that every member can see which dates carry no slack.

7. Cost-Time Trade-Off

Crashing is governed by a cost-time trade-off: the first days shortened from an activity are usually the cheapest to buy, and each additional day typically costs more than the last, as the easiest efficiencies

are used up first. This project's response to the CEO's "available, but not unlimited" budget constraint was to apply this logic in two stages. First, fast-tracking was used wherever activities could safely overlap, because it added no direct cost. Only the remaining, unavoidable gap in the schedule was closed through crashing, and even then, crashing was limited to two specific activities (8.0 and 9.0) rather than distributed across the full remaining timeline.

This selectivity matters because the original Rs. 80,000 project budget, carried over from Milestone 3, was a planning-level estimate rather than a vendor-confirmed figure (Risk Register R6). Committing additional spend broadly across the schedule would have risked a budget overrun requiring re-justification before the project could even reach agency confirmation. By confining the paid crash actions to the two activities where added resources have the clearest, most direct effect on duration, the team kept the additional cost small and traceable, funded from the roughly 10% contingency reserve already built into the Milestone 3 budget.

8. Risk Management

Compressing a schedule does not remove risk from a project; it concentrates it. A standalone Risk Register was produced alongside this compression decision, scoring each risk on probability and impact (1-5 scale) to produce a priority rating from Low to Critical. Table 3 reproduces the highest-priority entries relevant to this compression decision; the complete register, covering twelve identified risks across the full project, is submitted separately.

Table 3: Selected Risks and Responses

ID	Risk	Priority	Response	Key Mitigation
R12	Crashed critical path leaves near-zero float across almost every activity from 08 Aug to 08 Sep.	Critical	Mitigate	Treat every critical-path activity as zero-tolerance for delay; daily check-ins during the crashed phases (8.0, 9.0); escalate to the Sponsor immediately if any critical-path activity slips by more than half a day.
R1	Agency response delays cascade into the crashed schedule.	High	Mitigate	Contact multiple agencies per city in parallel from the start of sourcing; replace a non-responsive agency with a pre-identified backup within one working day.
R3	Candidate attrition/drop-off before onboarding reduces deployed headcount.	High	Mitigate	Confirm candidate intent by phone one day before onboarding; keep a standby shortlist ready to fill gaps same-day.
R9	Team member unavailability (coursework/exams) affects single-owner	Medium	Mitigate	Cross-train a backup owner for each critical-path activity; share the revised network diagram so every member knows which dates carry zero float.

ID	Risk	Priority	Response	Key Mitigation
	activities on the crashed critical path.			
R7	Training slots not pre-booked ahead of the crashed mobilization window.	Medium	Mitigate	Pre-book trainer and venue before the mobilization phase begins; keep a compressed one-day backup training module ready.
R6	Budget overrun, since the original Rs. 80,000 budget was planning-level rather than vendor-confirmed.	Medium	Mitigate	Track spend weekly against the phase-wise budget; draw on the built-in contingency reserve to fund the two temporary crash resources.

The single highest-rated risk in the register, R12, is a direct consequence of this compression exercise rather than a pre-existing project risk - a reminder that schedule compression is itself a risk-generating decision, and that the response to it (daily monitoring, defined escalation to the Sponsor) had to be built into the plan rather than left implicit.

9. Change Management

The schedule change originated as a direct instruction from the project sponsor, which under the project's Responsibility Matrix carries ultimate accountability ("A") for outcomes. Because the instruction explicitly preserved scope, the change was managed as a controlled revision of sequencing, duration, and resourcing rather than a renegotiation of deliverables. Three documents were revised as a linked set to keep the plan internally consistent: the Milestone 3 Gantt chart (updated dates, durations, and completion percentages from Phase 7.2 onward), the Milestone 4 network diagram (updated to show the resulting critical path and the new parallel execution note at Phase 8), and this report together with the accompanying Risk Register, which documents why the change was made and what new risks it introduces.

Ownership and accountability were preserved rather than reassigned: the same rotating-pair structure and the same team members remain responsible for the compressed activities. This kept the change contained to schedule mechanics, which is consistent with the sponsor's instruction that scope - and, by extension, who is responsible for delivering it - was not open for renegotiation.

10. Quality & Monitoring/Control

Protecting quality under a compressed schedule required deciding, deliberately, which activities should not be compressed. Judgment-dependent activities - discussing and finalising commercial terms with agencies, and preparing the final project report - were left at their original durations, since

rushing them risks a weaker outcome for a saving of at most a day or two. Compression was concentrated instead on activities whose speed is genuinely a function of available manpower.

Control under the revised plan rests on three mechanisms already reflected in the project's documentation. First, the Milestone 3 Gantt chart's percentage-complete column provides the monitoring baseline going forward: 1.0-7.1 at 100%, 7.2 at 45%, and every later phase at 0% until work begins, so progress against the compressed dates is visible at a glance. Second, standard requirement templates and first-contact screening (introduced to speed up agency engagement) also reduce variability in the information being worked with, which supports consistency of output even under time pressure. Third, and most directly tied to the near-zero float identified in Section 6, daily check-ins are required during the two crashed phases, with any slip beyond half a day escalated immediately to the Sponsor rather than absorbed silently - the only way to catch a threat to the 8 September date early enough to respond to it.

11. Conclusion

The CEO's directive to finish seven days earlier, without changing scope and within a limited but real budget, was met by applying standard schedule compression theory in a targeted way: fast-tracking wherever activities could safely overlap at no direct cost, and crashing only where resource-driven activities on the critical path genuinely benefited from additional temporary manpower. The result is a revised plan that completes on 8 September 2026 instead of 15 September 2026, with the full original scope intact and the additional cost limited to two temporary resource additions. The trade-off is a critical path with very little remaining float, which the project now manages through daily monitoring and a documented, escalation-ready risk response rather than through the wider planning buffers the original schedule allowed.